

An integrated development environment (IDE) is unnecessary in this case, as you will not even need to compile anything. However, working with one improves productivity as it will support syntax highlighting, code completion, and will warn you if you mistype anything.

Unless you plan to do some really heavy design work for your web site, Aptana Studio is a good choice. It isn't a WYSIWYG editor, which may be a turn-off if you intend to make complicated layouts. However, for getting your layout off the ground, you can use free and open source applications such as Komposer, or Amaya. If you really want to go for web development, Dreamweaver is a professional solution by Adobe.

So to effectively use this Fast Track to AJAX, you should have the following software installed on your computer:

- Aptana Studio
- Notepad++
- A Browser (preferably Mozilla Firefox with the FireBug addon)